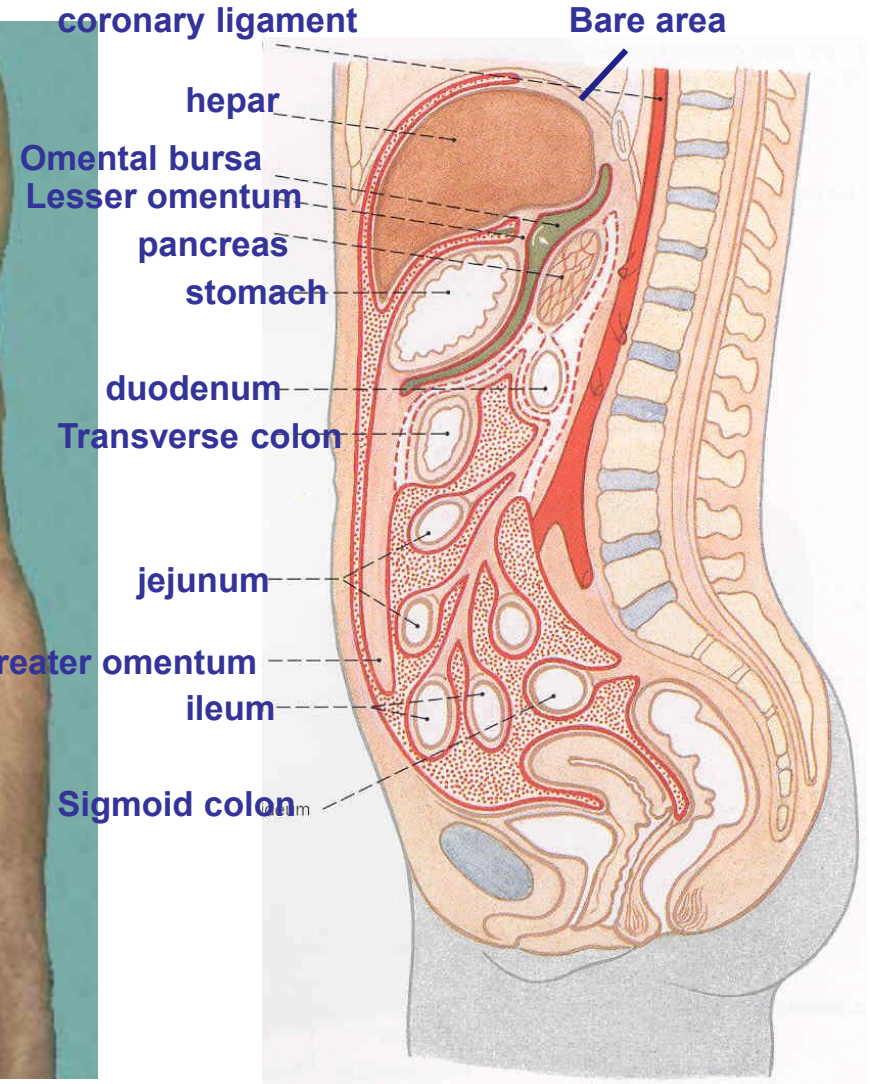
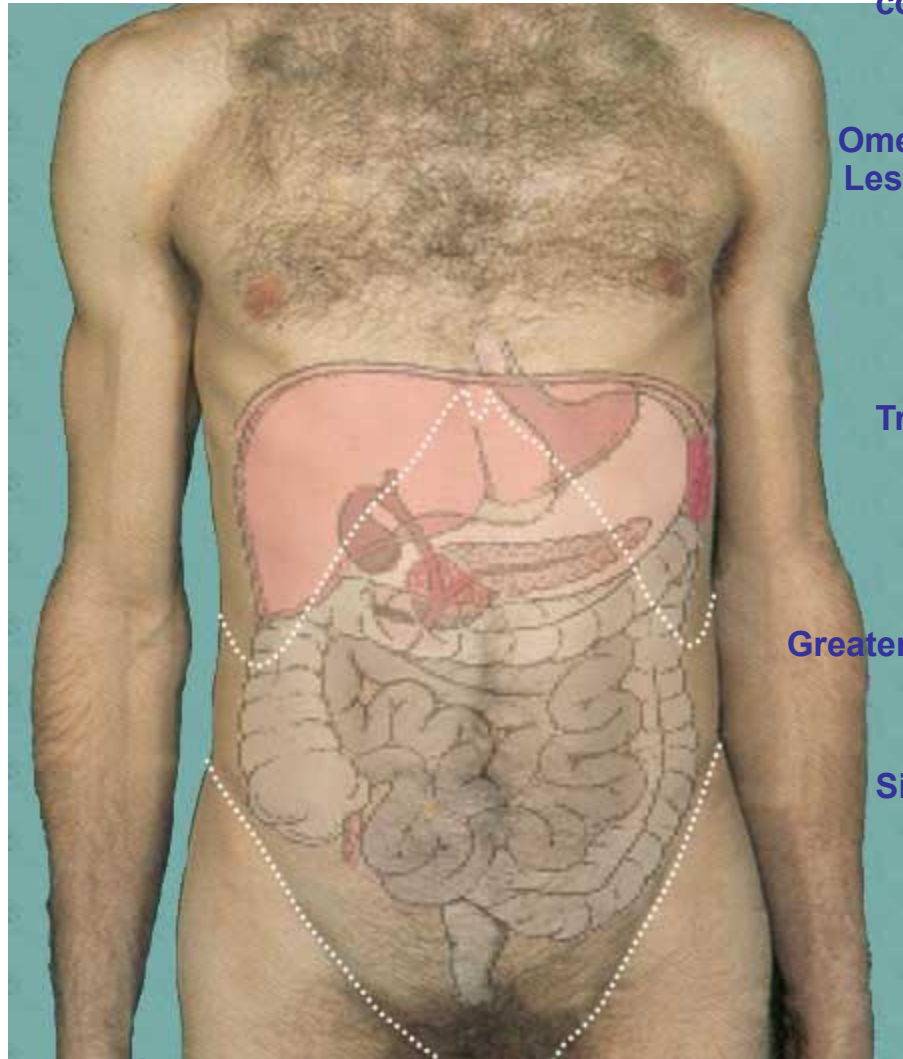


POSITION OF THE LARGE INTESTINE AND RECTUM



ANATOMICAL DIVISIONS

CECUM + vermiform appendix

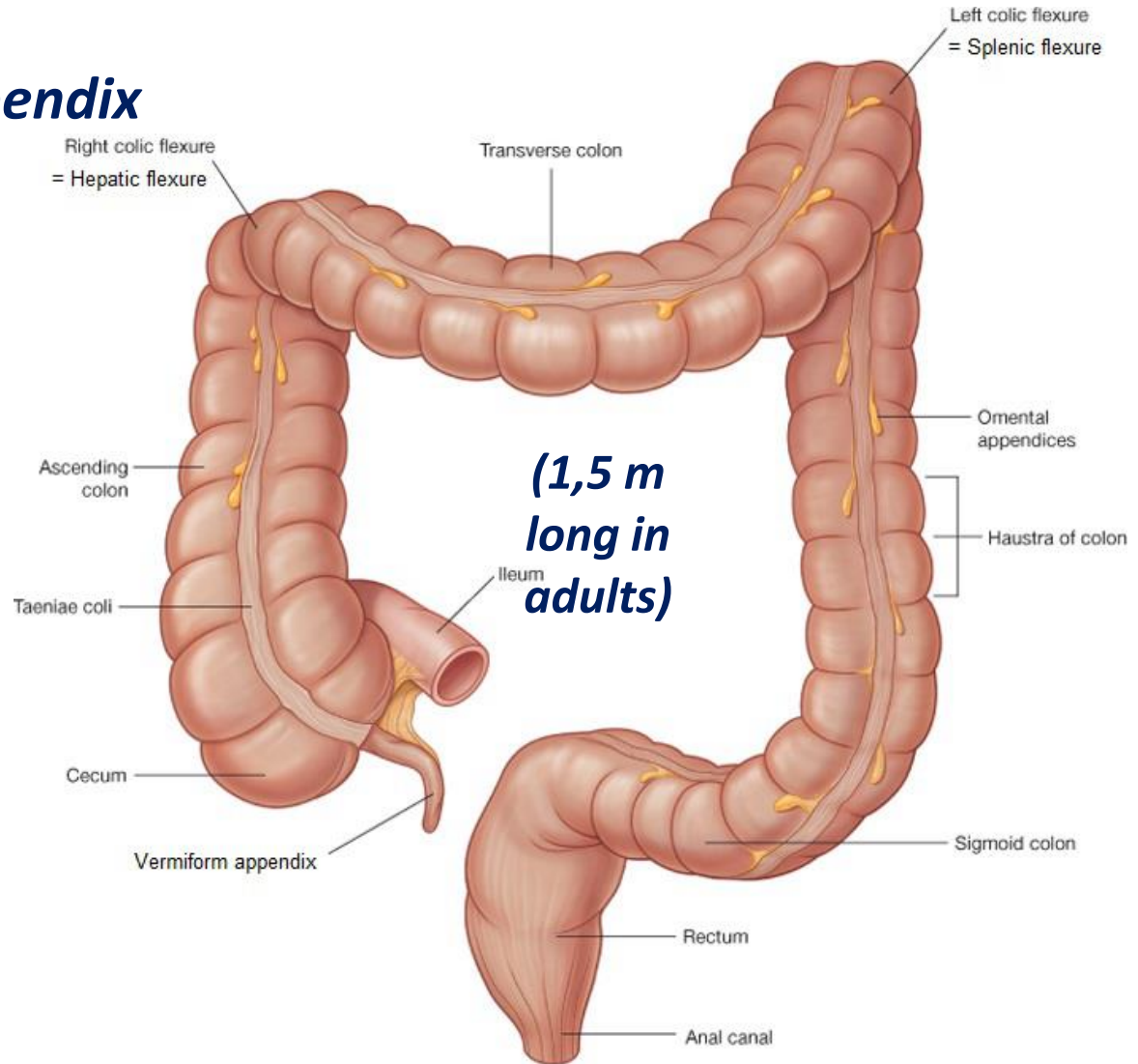
ASCENDING COLON

TRANSVERSE COLON

DESCENDING COLON

SIGMOID COLON

RECTUM



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HOW CAN WE DISTINGUISH THE LARGE AND SMALL INTESTINES?

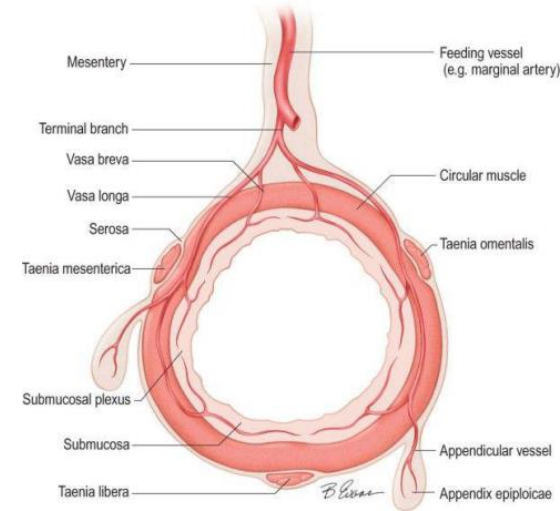
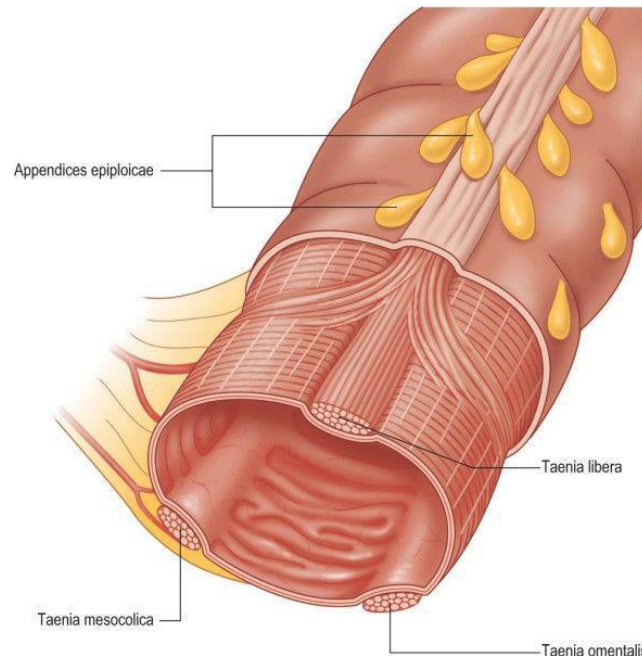
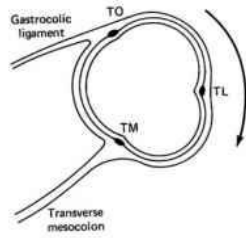
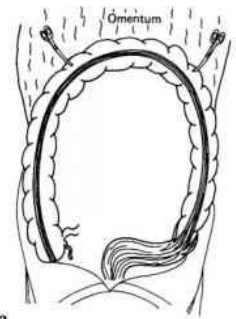
External features

Epiploic appendices - protrusions of the peritoneum filled with areolar /fatty connective tissue

Haustra (plural) - saccular dilations of the wall

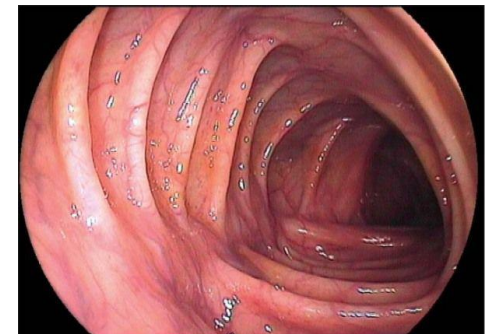
Taeniae (plural) - strong bands of the tunica muscularis (absent from the vermiform appendix, sigmoid colon and rectum)

Omental
Free
Mesocolic



Internal features

Semicircular folds
No villi



VERMIFORM APPENDIX AND CECUM

Located in the right iliac fossa

Both parts are mostly

INTRAPERITONAL

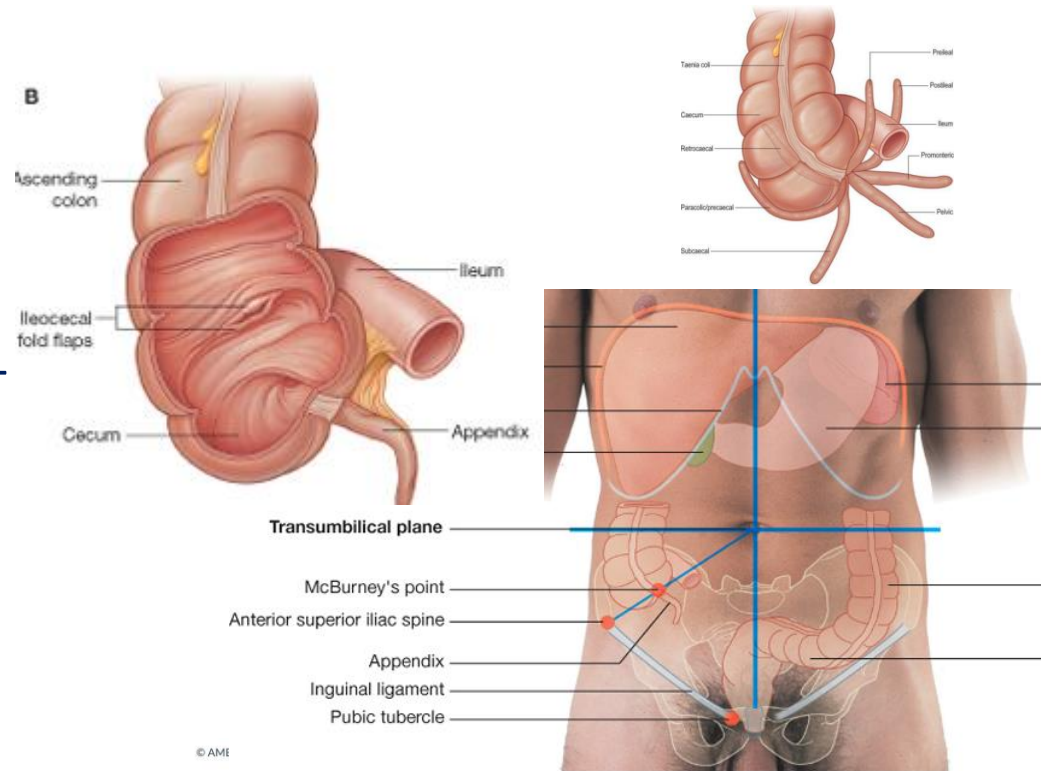
Ileocecal recesses (peritoneum)

Ileocecal orifice + Valve of Bauhin –
two lips (longitudinal muscle layer of
ileum)

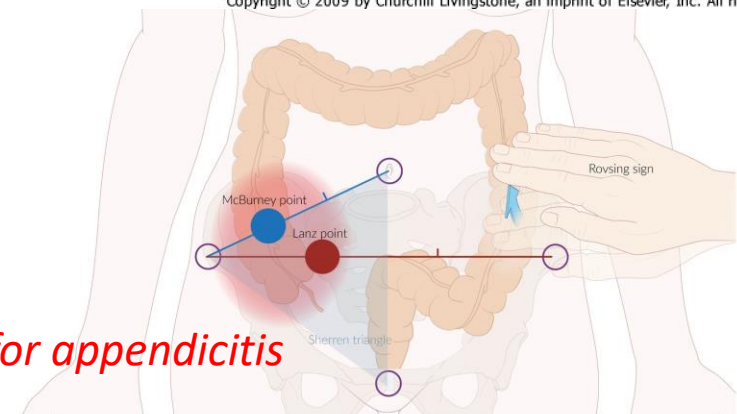
Vermiform appendix starts at the
merging of the 3 taeniae (McBurney
point) and ends at the Lanz's point
(approx 3-20 cm long)

RETROCECAL / RETROCOLIC
Great varieties in the position

Mesoappendix (if intraperitoneal)



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Pressure points for appendicitis

ASCENDING COLON

Continuation of the cecum

3 taeniae

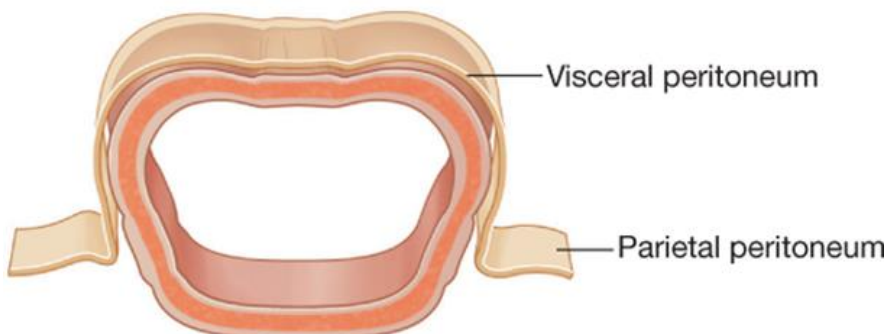
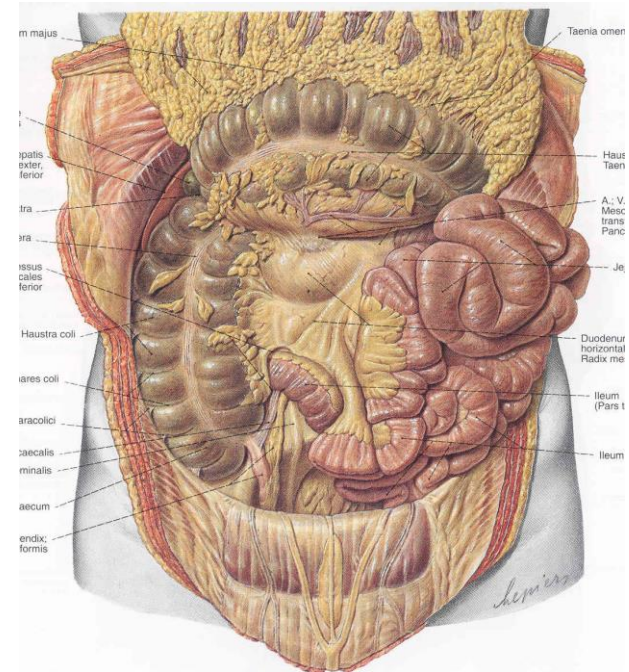
Partially intraperitoneal/retroperitoneal

Paracolic sulcus

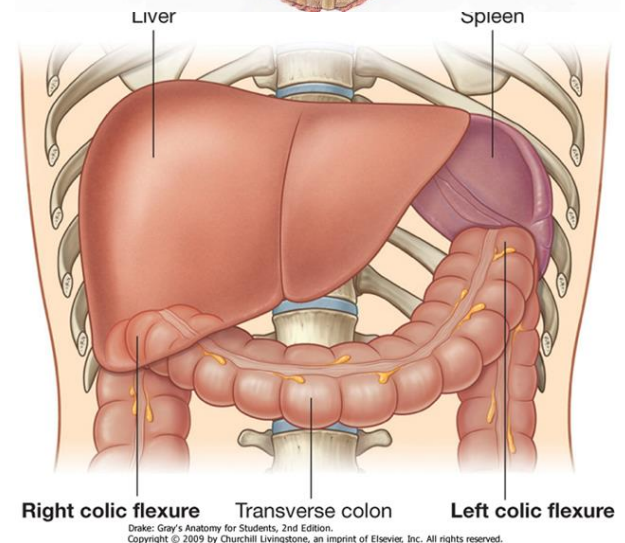
Position: lateral to the *midinguinal line*

- up to the *transpyloric plane*
- ends in the *right colic flexure*

Touches the posterior abdominal wall + right kidney



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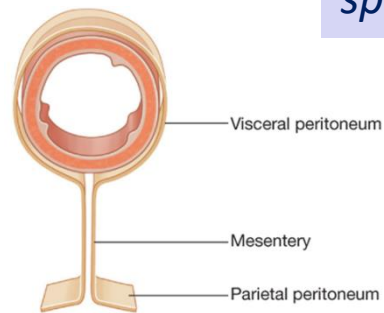
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TRANSVERSE COLON

Stretches from the **right colic flexure**
to the **left colic flexure**
(right lumbar region,
across the epigastrium to the
left hypochondrium)
then continues downwards
below the spleen

3 taeniae

Fully intraperitoneal



transverse mesocolon

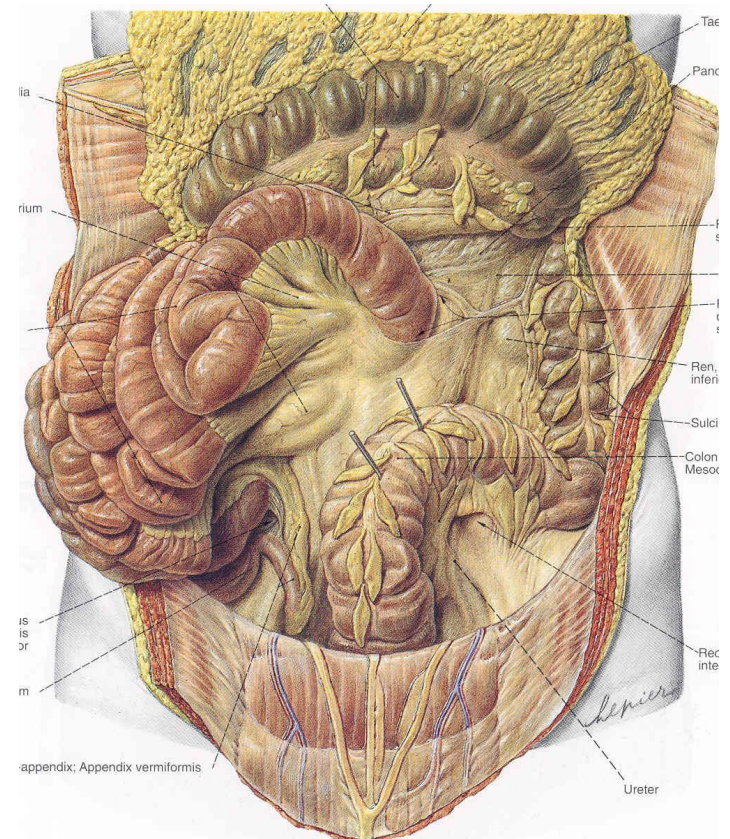
gastrocolic ligament (of the greater omentum)
connects to the greater curvature
of the stomach

Syntopy of the right colic flexure

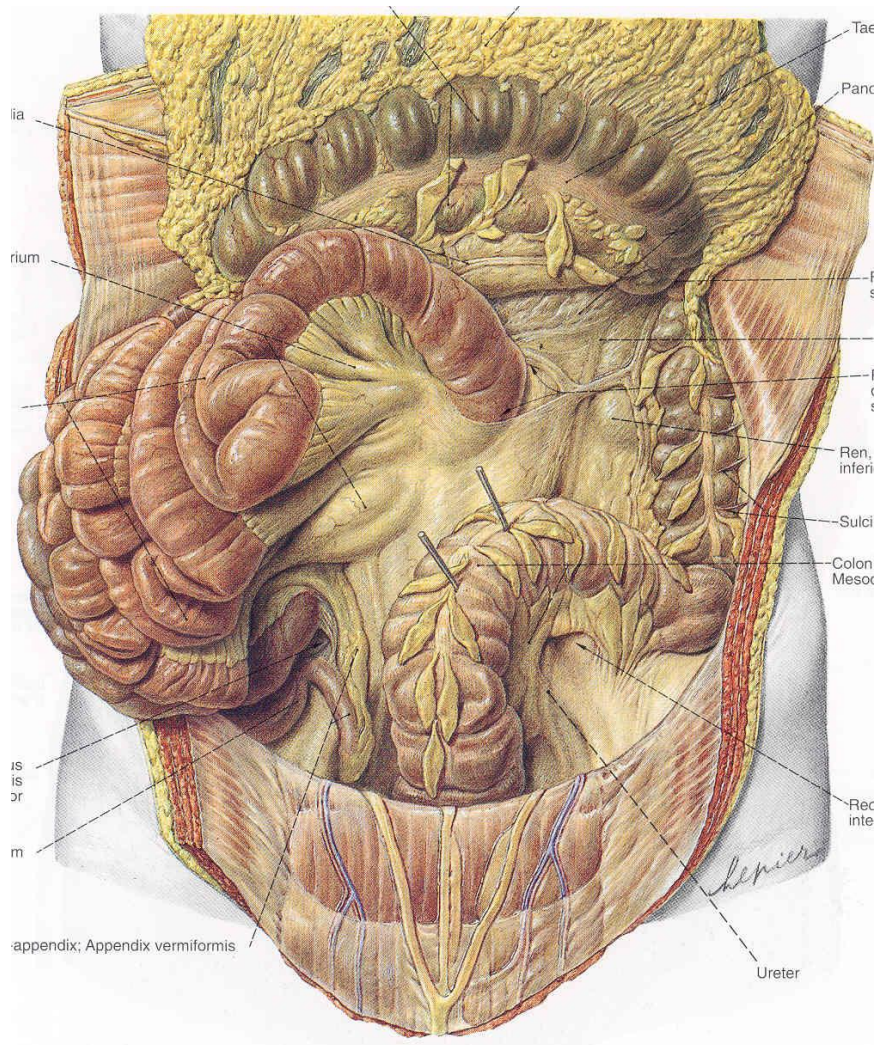
Right kidney
right lobe of liver (colic impression)
biliary vesicle
duodenum (desc part)

Syntopy of the left colic flexure

Lies higher than the right flexure
phrenicocolic ligament * 10-11th rib level
tail of pancreas
spleen (colic impression)



DESCENDING COLON



Continuation of the transverse colon
(*heading down to the left iliac fossa*)

Thinnest part of the large intestine
Develops from the hindgut

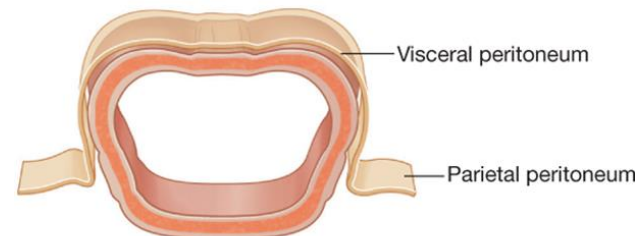
3 taeniae

Partially intraperitoneal/retroperitoneal

Paracolic sulcus

Position: lateral to the *midinguinal line*
- ends in the *sigmoid colon*

Touches the spleen, the posterior abdominal wall/diaphragm + left kidney



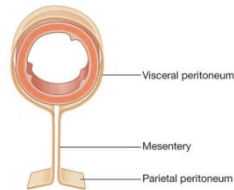
SIGMOID COLON

Descends from the left iliac fossa to the pelvis then ascends and again descends (***sigmoid looping***) to continue in the rectum at S3 level

Develops from the hindgut

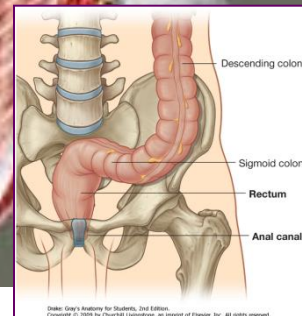
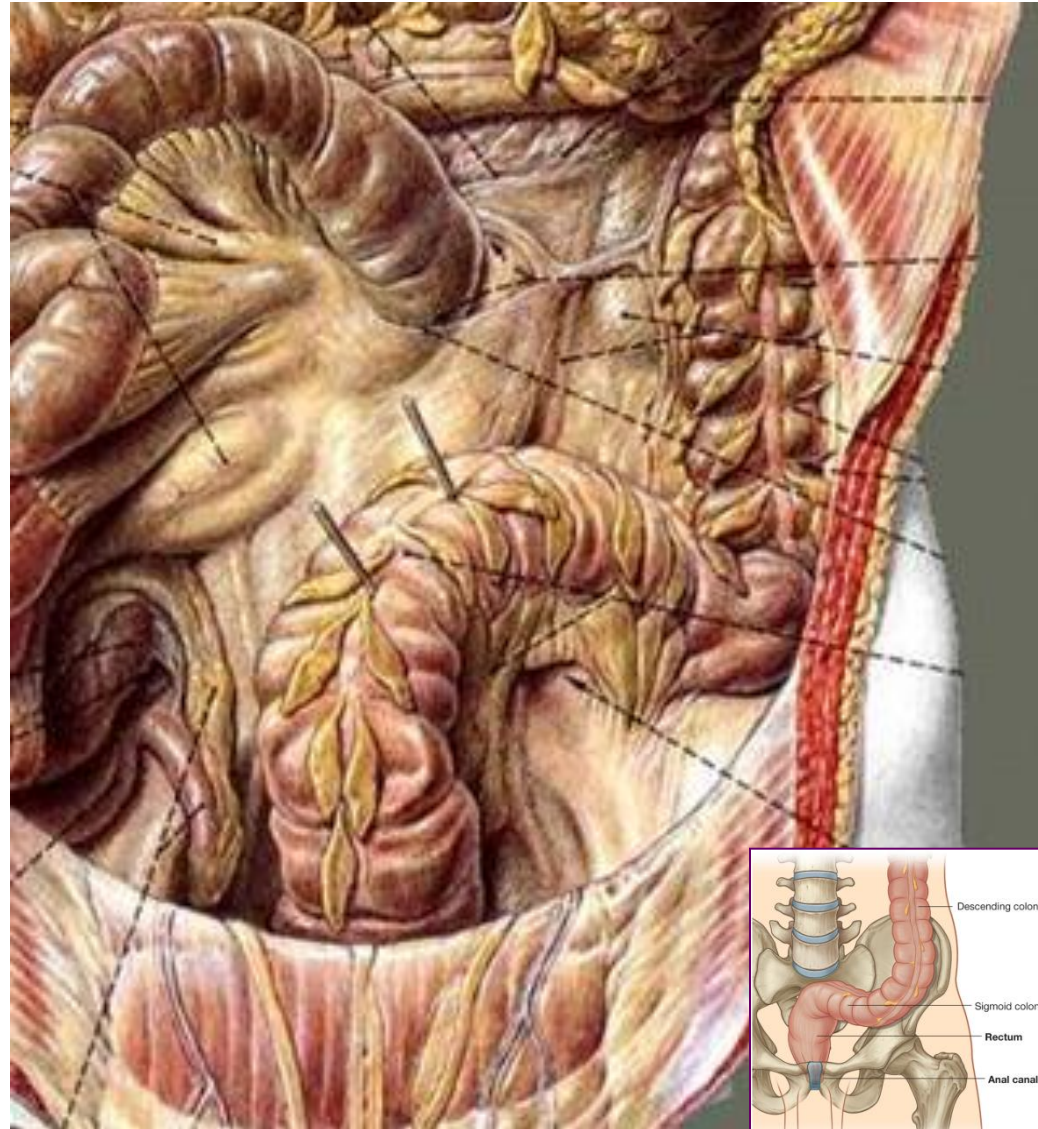
(3) → 2 taeniae

Intraperitoneal -
mesosigmoideum
mobile part of colon



Intersigmoid recess

Touches the loops of the small intestine and the pelvic organs
(M: bladder /rectum
F: uterus/rectum)



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